

The Lure in the Mist

Tuesday, 14 July 2026 · plot and bookkeeping: what changed, what is canon, rulings, threads, quotes

The GM's record of the session, spoiler-tolerant: the companion to the player recap. Nothing here was shown to the players.

Loose threads & hooks live at the table

- **The will-o'-wisp ESCAPED** — vanished mid-fight and never resurfaced (Lantern of Revealing swept the hall: gone). Gren swore an on-record vendetta: *"It tricked us — it, and all of its kind, in the future."* A fled wisp is a sequel hook by design (GM key). Decide where it drifts next.
- **The Greenrest Tonic is in Thomas's pack and the label was read aloud** — the party now knows Greenrest brews a dream-suppressing draught ("sleeps utterly, without dreams, for seven nights... nor say why anyone would brew such a thing") *before ever seeing the village*. First domino of the valley's secret. Expect them to ask Selma about it — or worse, drink it.
- **Goldthorn's mask is OFF** — identified at the table and attuned by Jetten (Faerie Fire 1/day, the "worthy hand" lore read aloud). **Dawnthorn no longer exists in the live world** (verified post-session): the world Items directory holds exactly ONE Gilded Scimitar — the Hidden Shrine folder master `LsTqXwIdBNwaYh9K`, `trueName` **Goldthorn** — plus Jetten's attuned copy. `world-state.md`'s "TWO masked scimitars (Dawnthorn + Goldthorn)" entry is stale cache (`world-state` syncs on request only — update it next sync). If Dawnthorn is meant to exist somewhere, it needs re-authoring.
- **The dead fey/elf beside the loot** — months dead, dagger still on the body (Goldthorn's "bearer lost to the webs"?). Unnamed, unexamined past a glance. A name/backstory is an open door — ties naturally to the Hidden Shrine loot's provenance.
- **The lintel line was never found.** "...a light, and a road home" (Ancient Structure GM page) went unread — Jetten's Perception 15 got only "etchings you can't possibly read." The thin-place/fey-veil layer also stayed hidden (Thomas Arcana 12 and 7 both missed the DC 15). The mystery is intact for a return visit — or stays lost, per the "longer thread than one night" note.
- **The blight-source thread is live.** Gren: "we need to find its source"; Morgash tried to backtrail (Survival 14). The blackened-sap trail from the GM key was never surfaced. The corruption-seep line ("it seeped in from somewhere deeper") remains available foreshadowing.
- **The larder had no living victims** — bones picked clean (Medicine 12/5 told them nothing more). The rescue-a-witness lever went unused; no survivor testimony about how the lights work.

- **The watchtower** overlooking Greenrest (~300 yards) was explicitly offered as a next-session option before descending. Prep it either way.

Bookkeeping — applied at the table (verify in world)

- **Loot (Item Piles, ~10:01–10:03 PM):** Jetten — Gilded Scimitar (**identified** → **Goldthorn, attuned overnight**) + Cloak of Elvenkind · Thomas — Lantern of Revealing + A Dose of Greenrest Tonic · Morgash — Potion of Healing · **67 gp each ×4** (pile auto-split).
- **⚠️ LEVEL 4 — milestone hit (reached Greenrest).** Players' homework before 2026-08-11: self-serve level-up to 4 in Foundry (feat/ASI choice at 4). Expect drive-by logins while the DM is idle — **have level-up support ready** (level-up-pc tool / inspect-pc-advancement), and verify all four sheets say 4 before next session.
- **Jetten recovered half his spent arrows** (+4 back to quiver) — he called it out explicitly; verify count.
- Long rest completed by all four (temple, night of day two). Keoghtom's Ointment: **2 doses consumed** by Morgash (of the jar's supply — verify remaining uses). Thomas spent 15 of his Lay on Hands pool; Gren burned both 2nd-level slots + sorcery points; all reset on the rest.
- **Lantern of Revealing:** Thomas equipped it; at the table it was treated as attunable ("another one of these items that somebody could attune to"). RAW (2024 DMG) it requires **no attunement** — decide before someone wastes a slot on it.
- **⚠️ NaN-attunement audit (2026-07-14, post-session): CORRUPTION RECURRED — found + repaired same night.** The --transfer tripwire probe passed (**BEHAVIOR-OK**, served file healthy), but 3 of the 5 table-transferred items arrived attunement: "NaN" anyway: **Goldthorn** (→ repaired to "required", attuned stays true), **Cloak of Elvenkind** (→ "required"), **Lantern of Revealing** (→ "" — 2024 needs no attunement; this bugged value is also why it looked attunable at the table). Tonic + Potion clean (the potion merged into an existing stack, bypassing the buggy path). Root cause reading: **the DM's Chrome ran a stale cached pre-hotfix module.js** — the transformer executes on the transferring client, so the server-side probe can't clear a session by itself. Evidence: notes repo evidence/nan-attunement-2026-07-14-session2-loot.md. **🔒 New standing rule: hard-reload the DM's Foundry tab (Ctrl+Shift+R) before any session with Item Piles transfers** — and keep the post-session audit standing (second consecutive transfer session that didn't audit clean).

Rules & rulings made at the table (now precedent)

- **Lair actions introduced** (run at initiative 20, "you can beat it with higher initiative") — the wisp entered on the lair beat. First use in this campaign.
- **Cover as attacker penalty:** DM applied **−2 on the attack roll** for half cover / shooting through an ally's space (RAW is +2 AC to the target — same math, keep the convention consistent).
- **Precision Attack clarified:** adds to the attack roll only, never to damage (came up twice with Anthony).
- **Re-roll rule reaffirmed:** Gren re-rolled a Scorching Ray attack made without his advantage ("I'll take the risk") — wrong-mode rolls get redone, even fishing for crits.
- **Subtle Spell / Spellfire Burst reading settled:** Spellfire Burst triggers on spending ≥ 1 sorcery point as part of a Magic action **or bonus action** — metamagic isn't required to arm it; the feature text's phrasing was agreed to be sloppy. (Gren used Subtle+Magic Missile anyway for the wisp — fine.)
- **Healing-doubled house rule: not visibly applied this session.** Lay on Hands healed exactly the points spent (10, then 5); Healing Word applied as rolled (11); Keoghtom's as rolled (10, 14). Either the rule quietly lapsed or nobody flagged it — **confirm whether "all healing doubled" still stands** before it matters at low HP.
- 2024 KO/subdual, Sap/Slow/Vex/Graze masteries, Dreadful Strike (2d6 psychic, PB/long rest, any turn) all ran clean via the sheet feats built post-session-1.

Fix-list (observed tech/content issues)

- **Ettercap Multiattack card shows a broken enricher:** "makes one .mmBite0000000000 attack" — a mangled UUID/reference in the Multiattack description on the Ettercap actor(s). Fix the text on Ettercap (and check Broodling/Broodmother variants).
- **Players can't apply compendium effects to themselves** ("only the GM can do that" — Gren's Mage Armor drag failed; DM applied it manually, twice). Decide: raise player permissions for effect application, or fold into the automation rollout.
- **Gren's client was pause-blocked at combat start** — world pause (deliberate, anti-wander) also blocked his sheet interactions ("my game is paused and I can't get on my character"). Consider unpausing at initiative, or check whether fvtt-mod-openserver/pause behavior can exempt sheet UI.
- **Light spell never mechanically applied to Thomas** — cast twice in the fiction, hand-waved at the cave ("we'll just say Thomas has light"). Harmless, but the recurring pattern is spell-effect application friction (same root as Mage Armor above).

- **A stray duplicate PC token** appeared when dragging the party onto the forest scene ("there's two of you now") — DM cleaned up live; worth a quick scene audit for orphans.
- **Automation rollout planned** (DM, on-record): after ~1–2 more sessions, turn on auto-apply damage/riders. Players are now targeting-proficient; this session ran visibly smoother than session 1 (carousel, skull icons, initiative gate all praised).
- **Pipeline note (5090 box):** Windows Application Control now blocks the session-scribe venv's python.exe trampoline. Workaround that worked tonight: run the uv **base** interpreter (AppData\Roaming\uv\python\cpython-3.12.13...\python.exe) with PYTHONPATH → venv site-packages and the three nvidia*\bin dirs prepended to PATH. Transcription was otherwise flawless (large-v3, 5 tracks in ~11 min).

Quotes of the night

- *"One of our fairy friends may be in distress — we should investigate."* — Gren, taking the bait exactly as designed
- *"How delightful. It was a trap, guys."* — Jetten, spotting the ettercap ambush mid-sneak
- *"You were so great leading us through the woods... what did you roll, like a zero for initiative?"* — Jetten, as Morgash followed a day of Survival 23/21 with a natural 1
- *"He was dating Lae'zel for a while... and she dumped him."* — the DM, on Morgash's Baldur's Gate years; Morgash: *"She broke my heart."* Gren: *"A little too bony for my likes."*
- *"You don't know shit about will-o'-wisps."* — the DM, adjudicating Thomas's Arcana 7
- *"We're going to call you Thomas the Silent."* — Jetten, after the flat-out crit
- *"Let's not eat the mushrooms, guys."* — Jetten
- *"So cool. You're such an edge lord."* — Jetten, attuning to Goldthorn
- *"We're going to seek vengeance on that will-o'-wisp. It tricked us — it, and all of its kind, in the future."* — Gren
- *"This was the learning curve. It's going to get harder now."* — the DM, closing
- Meta but worth keeping: the players spontaneously praised the emailed session summaries ("so cool... so thoughtful") — DM: "the whole thing is wired up to Claude."

Scheduling

- **Next session: Tuesday 2026-08-11, 8:00 PM ET** — Robert put it on his calendar at the table; DM will send an email around the date.

- Two players are abroad until **2026-08-10** — "I'll suck it up and deal with the jet lag."
- Between now and then: players level to 4 remotely; DM prep = Greenrest village + watchtower + shard-choice fork.

NaN audit result (2026-07-14, post-session): 3× NaN found on session-2 loot (Goldthorn, Cloak of Elvenkind, Lantern of Revealing) — **repaired same night**; details in the Bookkeeping section above and notes repo `evidence/nan-attunement-2026-07-14-session2-loot.md`.

One more player-facing follow-up from the audit: Jetten's **Cloak of Elvenkind is not attuned** (he attuned only Goldthorn) — its stealth/perception magic is dormant until he spends a slot on it. Worth telling Drew alongside the level-4 homework.

GM-only. Compiled from the transcript, the chat log and the live sheets by the session scribe.